sadness about the kidnappings. They know kidnapping is wrong but they have no other forum to present their cause to the world.

They also asked that the American government's foreign policy in the Middle East be just. Presently, it is one sided: pro-Israel. And not all Arabs are oil millionaires. There are millions of poor Arabs in the Middle East who have legitimate human needs and rights that are denied them.

My captors in those final minutes stressed that they do not want the Syrians to be involved in any negotiations on the release of the other three Americans.

I have given you the message that I gave the Pope in Rome, John Paul II. I do this so that you know its contents. I did not tell them of the condition of the 17 of Kuwait. I am sure they know.

I pray to our dearest God I have recalled well those final conversations and I have honestly conveyed their messages.

Mr. President, there were times I did not have kind and charitable thoughts about my government, my Servite order, my church and the C.R.S. I have asked God's forgiveness for these sinful [thoughts] and ask your forgiveness, too. Thank you for your prayers and all that you have done on our behalf. In the future, I might still get angry—bear with me.

May the God of Abraham, Isaac and Jacob, of Jesus, of Mohammed, our God, answer our prayers, for the release of our fellow Americans . . . still held hostage somewhere.

With gratitude.
Father Lawrence Martin Jenco
Servite